



Providing Creative Solutions to Common Problems

HOME-SERVICES RECEIVABLES RECOVERY · CAPABILITIES OVERVIEW

Debt Collection for Home-Services Contractors

Recovering unpaid job invoices, deposits & progress balances — on pure contingency

Prepared for **Home Trades** · July 2026

A recovery partner for the jobs that never get paid

To James and the Home Trades team — thank you for reaching out. Every home-services and trades business runs into the same problem: the work gets done, the crew moves to the next job, and a handful of customers never pay. A completed-job invoice, an unpaid balance after a deposit, or a disputed change order sits on the books while you focus on the next call.

Unpaid jobs aren't a paperwork problem — they're earned money walking out the door. For a contractor, chasing a past-due customer means time off the tools and awkward calls that put your reviews and referrals at risk — so the balance quietly gets written off.

Southwest Recovery Services works contractor and home-services receivables on **pure contingency since 2004**. We do the chasing so you don't have to — **reputation-first**, fully compliant, and professional, with skip tracing to locate a customer who's gone quiet. You send us the unpaid accounts through a secure portal; we handle the rest. No recovery, no fee.

Two decades of receivables recovery — nationwide

A documented, compliant recovery process a busy trades business can hand off completely — no software to buy, no collection calls to make, no risk to the name on your truck.

2004 Recovering commercial receivables since	\$975M+ Receivables placed (all industries)	\$76M+ Recovered for clients	800K+ Accounts worked
52% of placed accounts see a recovery	50 states — nationwide recovery reach	4.9★ Google client rating	\$0 upfront — no recovery, no fee

Commercial & B2B collections since 2004

Nationwide — all 50 states

12 offices across 7 states

Skip tracing on businesses & principals

Contingency — no recovery, no fee

RECOGNIZED & FEATURED BY

USA TODAY

FINANCIAL SERVICES
Review

FSR • TOP 10 LIST
2025 Recognition

INTERNATIONAL
Business Times

CFO Tech
Outlook

insideARM

ACCREDITED & RECOGNIZED



 ★ 4.9 · 38 Google reviews

Memberships: **ACA International** · TAA · AAGD · NARPM

The questions a contractor asks — answered directly

Exactly how we work, in plain terms, before a single account is placed.

YOUR QUESTION	SOUTHWEST RECOVERY SERVICES
1. Fee structure	Pure contingency — \$0 upfront, no retainer, no monthly minimum. You pay a pre-agreed percentage only of what we actually recover. Nothing comes out of pocket to start — if we don't collect, you owe nothing.
2. Will this hurt my reviews and referrals?	This matters most for a business that lives on word of mouth, and it's how we're built. Recovery is professional and fully compliant — no threats, no misrepresentation. We represent Home Trades the way you would, so a past-due customer is handled firmly but respectfully.
3. What can we place?	Completed-job invoices a customer never paid, balances left after a deposit or down payment, progress-billing balances on larger jobs, and disputed change orders you've documented. Residential balances are consumer debt (worked under FDCPA / Reg F); commercial and property-manager accounts are worked as B2B.
4. What about a customer who's gone quiet?	Skip tracing to locate the customer and, on commercial accounts, the business and its principals — then persistent, documented demand. Locating a non-responsive customer is exactly where an outside agency outperforms doing it yourself.
5. How do I hand off an account?	Low-lift. Send the customer name and contact info, what they owe, and the invoice or work order — a simple spreadsheet works. Upload it through our secure portal and outreach begins within 24–48 hours. No new software to learn.

Simple hand-off and full visibility, on demand

Every account you place is managed through our secure portal — built so a busy contractor can hand off a balance in minutes and check on it any time.

PLACEMENT IN MINUTES

Upload a simple spreadsheet or the job record — customer, balance, contact and invoice. We map your columns; no special software or re-keying.

REAL-TIME STATUS

Check what's been recovered and what's still in progress on demand — no phone tag.

SECURE DOCUMENT EXCHANGE

Send the invoice, estimate, work order or signed change order safely inside the portal — the paper that settles a dispute fast.

DIRECT-PAYMENT REPORTING

If a customer pays you directly after you place the account, log it in a click so we stop contacting them and your books stay right.

► **Portal Video Tour**

SWRS Home-Services & Trades Case Studies

Actual placed-versus-recovered results from Southwest Recovery's **trades and home-services book** — HVAC, plumbing, electrical, roofing, drywall and general contractors — anonymized by trade, individual client names withheld. Real recovered dollars on placed accounts.

**DRYWALL & FINISHING
CONTRACTOR**

Interior trades

\$20K recovered

of ~\$20K placed

100% recovered

ROOFING CONTRACTOR

Exterior & roofing

\$36K recovered

of ~\$41K placed

89% recovered

ELECTRICAL CONTRACTOR

Residential & commercial

\$19K recovered

of ~\$22K placed

89% recovered

**HVAC & MECHANICAL
CONTRACTOR**

Heating & cooling

\$16K recovered

of ~\$18K placed

87% recovered

PLUMBING CONTRACTOR

Service & install

\$35K recovered

of ~\$44K placed

79% recovered

HVAC CONTRACTOR

Multi-crew operation

\$68K recovered

of ~\$137K placed

49% recovered

Anonymized by sector from Southwest Recovery's book; individual client names withheld. Results vary by account age, balance, documentation quality and industry. We do not publish blended portfolio averages.

THE COST OF WAITING

Why unpaid jobs recover best while they're fresh

A balance is most collectible while the job is fresh — the work was recent, the customer's contact details are current, and they remember exactly what you did. Every month it ages, people move, numbers change, and the balance competes with newer bills. The highest-leverage move a busy contractor can make isn't chasing harder — it's handing it off sooner.

THE AGE CURVE

Fresh balances (under ~90–120 days past due) resolve at materially higher rates; balances left a year or more collect a fraction of that.

THE STANDING RULE

A simple “hand it off at 90 days” habit recovers more than letting balances drift toward write-off — and on contingency there's no cost to placing.

Real placed-versus-recovered results from SWRS's trades and home-services book, anonymized by trade; individual client names withheld. Results vary by account age, balance size and documentation; we give an honest, age-based read on a representative sample first.

We understand a contractor ledger

A trades business creates a specific set of unpaid balances. Our playbook is built for exactly that.



Unpaid completed-job invoices

The work got done and the customer never paid. We pursue the balance professionally so you don't have to make the awkward call.



Deposit & progress balances

Balances left after a deposit and progress-billing balances on larger jobs — worked exactly when they stall.



Disputed change orders

Documented change-order balances a customer is refusing to pay — validated against your signed paperwork, then recovered.



Skip tracing & compliance

We locate customers who've gone quiet, and work every consumer account under FDCPA / Reg F — protecting the name on your truck.

Recovery run on an AI-driven platform — Aktos

Every account SWRS works runs on Aktos, a next-generation, AI-driven collections platform — with compliance built into the workflow, not bolted on afterward. It's how a boutique, people-first agency delivers enterprise-grade speed, consistency, and auditability.



AI workflow automation

Repetitive steps are automated and every account is scored and routed by predicted payment likelihood — so the right strategy reaches the right account first, without manual queue-picking.



Omnichannel outreach

Coordinated email, SMS, and voice, timed to when a debtor is most likely to engage — replacing high-friction call blasts with respectful, data-driven contact.



Compliance built in

FDCPA, Reg F, and TCPA guardrails are enforced inside the automation, with phone-number and consent checks before outreach — documented and defensible on every account.



Real-time dashboards

You see status, segmentation, and recovery performance on your portfolio in real time — full transparency, not a monthly PDF.



API-first intake

Secure SFTP/API placement means accounts start working without data lag — roughly 50% faster acknowledgment and validation of new placements.



Data-driven scoring

Dynamic scoring and segmentation predict payment likelihood and concentrate effort where recovery is most achievable — earlier intervention that trims DSO and reduces disputes.

The result is the combination clients rarely get from a legacy agency: faster cash and cleaner compliance at the same time. Automation accelerates recovery and standardizes documentation, while empathy-first, data-driven contact protects your brand and keeps disputes and complaints low.

Built by a collector with 30 years on the phones — not a CEO with zero collection experience



Steven Dietz

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

Featured in USA Today, International Business Times & Financial Services Review — Top AR Management Service, 2025 · ACA International member.

Steven Dietz didn't come to collections from the corner office — he came from the phones. He started as a collector and credit analyst before he was 20, was tapped by Aaron's to train collectors across 100+ locations, and has spent nearly 30 years in receivables. Along the way he became convinced the industry's bad reputation was a choice, not a requirement: businesses get paid faster when recovery is built on listening and respect rather than aggressive calls and empty threats.

He founded Southwest Recovery Services in 2004 on that principle — a national, family-owned receivables partner that treats every debtor as a person and every client relationship as worth protecting. Two decades later he still coaches the teams and works accounts personally — an operator who has actually done the job, not a manager who has only overseen it.

“Regardless of the means of recovery, our focus is always on preserving goodwill and representing the client professionally.”

— Steven Dietz, Founder & Chief Executive Officer, Southwest Recovery Services

Take it with you

Download this overview and the supporting white papers to share with your team.



This capabilities overview

PDF · prepared for Home Trades

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The Cost of Waiting: Receivables & Recovery

Why aging kills recovery · PDF

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The Placement-File Standard

Maximizing recovery · PDF

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The Aktos Advantage

Our AI-driven collections platform · PDF

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The Experian Intelligence Advantage

Data & skip-tracing stack · PDF

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The Recovery Waterfall

Full recovery lifecycle · PDF

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Let's turn your unpaid jobs back into cash.

A quick call to walk through the invoices you've written off, answer your questions, and put a contingency rate against a representative sample of your accounts — no cost, no obligation.

[Book a 30-minute discovery call →](#)

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12 offices across 7 states · nationwide recovery. Consumer & commercial collections · FDCPA / Reg F compliant · ACA International member. Private & confidential — prepared for Home Trades.